

Sample Writing answers



Additional sample Writing answers
in Resource Bank

TEST 1, WRITING TASK 1

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 5.5** score.

The first table shows changes in total population of New York city from 1800 to 2000. In 1800, New York's population was 79.216 then in 100 years the population sharply increased as over 4 times in 1800. Next 100 years, it still became more as it increased over twice as much as in 1800. Other two tables show changes of population in five different areas in New York. In 1800 Manhattan has 60.515 On the other hand other four areas, Brookly, Bronx, Queens and Staten Island had only 18.701. Manhattan has almost three times more than group of other four cities also. It had 76% of population in New York. It tells us Manhattan was the busiest city in New York. In 1900, Manhattan's populat increased sharply however, other broughs had bigger change. Population rate rise dramatically as 1587.109.

In 2000 other broughs had 6471.089 and 81% of population of New York. On the other hand Manhattan's population has dicreased and it became only 19% of New York population. Last 200 years people chose to live differant cities in New York.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This response is a good attempt at the task; however, selected information is limited and there are some inaccuracies. For example, data for Manhattan are minimal, and there is some inaccuracy, [*in 1900 ... other broughs had bigger change*]. There is also a small error in the final sentence, [*chose to live differant cities*], this should be 'different districts' because the city is New York City. The score is also impacted by the lack of an overview. The last sentence is an attempt at an overview, but is not sufficiently specific.

The information is arranged coherently, with some good use of cohesive devices [*then in | on the other hand | it | however*] but there is repetition [*on the other hand | in*], and the range could be wider.

Vocabulary is generally adequate, with some good examples [*sharply increased | dramatically | chose to live*], but there are some noticeable spelling errors [*populat | dicreased | differant*]. Similarly, grammatical range is limited in this response. Some good use of comparative structures [*increased over twice as much as | has almost three times more than | was the busiest*]; however, there are errors, including choice of tenses and missing articles.

TEST 1, WRITING TASK 2

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 6.5** score.

Access to pure clean water is for sure a necessary right for all human beings. It is one of the things needed to survive on this planet. Now, some people might argue that only and only water is required and the state of cleanliness of it should be a secondary thing to ensure, while other argue that there is no point in having water which, in some cases is not clean. can result to be fatal.

However all this debate comes down to one point whether or not this water shall be free of cost for humans Let us look at it from a more familiar approach. All humans on earth have free will and a sight to life; what will happen if one day someone comes up to us and says that is is he or she who owns the ait that we breathe in and just like that forces us to pay for over lives. This would not be acceptable to any human and they would be taking measures against

Just like that our earth was created with all the water it had even before humans came into existence hence proving us that no person or no government is the sole protector of the earth's water resources.

Water was created for the dwellers of soil and creatures of the sea and all mankind to utilize. The creator of it did not ask us to pay for it by any means of money then who are we to charge for such a basic thing which we do not even own?

We all have seen countries going to work claiming the ownership of the water resources and if one of them does win all the effort goes down to nothing when in the end they tax their own countrymen for it.

It is there that access to clean water is a basic human right. Therefore every home should as water supply is free. It is the responsibility of the authorities to look after the needs of the people as it them who declared clean water as a basic right.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is a good response that provides relevant ideas. The writer expresses their position, and agrees with the statement that access to clean water should be free, although there is some repetition and some lack of clarity within the main ideas expressed.

There are supporting arguments that include: whether any kind of water, or only 'clean water' should be provided, whether people should be allowed to 'own' the air we breathe and force people to pay for it, whether any person should be the [sole protector] of the water supply and whether the aim is to [tax their own countrymen] for water. The conclusion states that governments have declared that clean water is a basic right, and so they should look after the needs of the people, and provide [every home] with a free water supply.

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Ideas are generally logically organised, but there is a lack of progression around the sections that refer to the ownership of water on planet earth, with repetition across three paragraphs (2,3 and 4). However, generally, ideas are arranged in order and we can follow the progression through the response. Cohesive devices are used to some good effect, including referencing within sentences [*while | us | who | their own countrymen*]. However, paragraphing is not used effectively to sequence ideas, so more effective paragraphing could increase the score.

There are some strong examples of vocabulary [*comes down to one point | forces us to | look after the needs of*] with some higher-level collocation. However, the level of error is quite high and detracts from the score for lexis. Grammatical range is also fairly wide, but again, the errors and missing punctuation mean that the response cannot score more highly.

To achieve a higher score, the candidate should provide greater clarity when extending the main ideas, and use more effective paragraphing to organise ideas and improve progression.

TEST 2, WRITING TASK 1

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 6.0** score.

If we look at the pictures we will see how Beechwood Farm has changed along the time.

Years ago, in 1950, Beechwood Farm was a tipycal farm. A track crossed the farm, so farmers could reach the barn and the farmhouse passing by the fruit trees, and the place where the soft fruits and the vegetables were growing. At the opposite side of the truck, was the field where the sheeps were situated. That was close to the farmhouse, were chickens were also situated. All the farm was sourrounded, at the south, by a river.

Nowadeys, the farm has suffered changes. Modern life brought to the farm some needs to survive. The main change was the road that replaced the track. Now is easier to arrive any place in the farm.

There is a parking zone near the road where the sheeps used to eat grass. We can also find a camping field and Solar panels in that zone.

Another parking zone can be find where the solar panels are situated.

Just in front of the first parking zone we can see a farm shop. The old barn was replaced for a holiday cottoges, and relocated close to the chickens, near the river.

Lot of things have changed since 1950, and Beechwood Farm is not an exception. Modern times had come, and everyone had to be adjusted to new ways of living. We still have Beechwood Farm, but a new sophisticated and modern one.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This response addresses all of the changes illustrated in the farm plans. The writer describes how the farm looked in 1950, then moves on to the present-day plan. There is an overview in the last paragraph [*Lot of things have changed since 1950, and Beechwood Farm ... a new sophisticated and modern one*] but it does not mention the link to attracting visitors, so is not complete.

Information is generally arranged coherently. The first two paragraphs cover the 1950s site, with the remainder focused on the farm today. There is evidence of linking expressions [*At the opposite side | That | Nowadeys*]; however, there is a lack of reference, resulting in repetition [*farm | zone*].

Vocabulary is generally good [*parking zone | relocated | exception | adjusted | sophisticated*] but errors remain [*along the time / over time | tipycal | sourrounded | Nowadeys | easier | cottoges*].

Grammatical range is mixed. There are examples of complex sentence forms, including [*If*] clauses and modal forms [*could reach | can also find*] but there are also a range of errors which preclude a higher score.

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To improve the score, an overview that summarises the main changes should be added. It would also be beneficial to show greater accuracy in vocabulary and use of grammatical structures.

Example overview

These plans of the farm illustrate the updated facilities that have been added since 1950, which include accommodation, power generation and other additions to appeal to visitors and holidaymakers.

TEST 2, WRITING TASK 2

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 7.0** score.

In today's world, education is a must to every child and individual across every country. The duration of summer holidays became a major thing in terms of priority in some countries like in middle eastern location. Where as cold countries which experience long winters have concentrated less on summer holidays giving only few weeks for summer vacations.

On the otherside, a regular family would like to spend most of the time in summer holidays by travelling to their homeland, meeting their relatives and seek long durations for summer, so that children can spend valuable time with cousins and relatives making valuable memories. On the other hand, some parents who work 365 days would find it difficult to take care of children during summer holidays as they have to work and prefer shorter period of holidays.

This has become a major problem and is affecting children in a bad way. Childhood is to cherish some good valuable memories along with studies. Longer summer breaks allow the children to make time to visit family relatives and this early relationship helps to maintain a stronger bond for the rest of the life. Once they are out of school, they have to work and make a living for themselves where they won't find time for their loved ones.

Coming to shorter school holidays, they help the children from falling back in studies (or) having interest. With longer duration of holidays children take a lot of time to get back their concentration after the school starts. It has both positive and negative side to it. Shorter school holidays help the student to maintain concentration, performance but at the same time they won't form special bonds which are really important.

From my perspective, maintaining strong relationship bonds is more important than just education which requires a longer duration of summer holidays.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is an appropriate response, with a series of ideas for each part, presented effectively. It starts with a note that different countries have different patterns. The value of long holidays include families being able to travel and spend time with relatives, as once children leave school, they won't have the free time to develop these strong bonds. The arguments for shorter holidays mention families where parents work and cannot take so much leave, and that it helps children not to fall behind in their studies. The candidate concludes that stronger family bonds are more important, so longer holidays are best. There is some minor repetition in the ideas presented.

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Ideas are logically organised, and cohesive devices are varied. Reference is used [*This* | *they* | *their*] but some inaccuracy in linking devices [*Where as* | *On the otherside* | *Coming to*], and some repetition [*relatives* | *valuable*] limits the rating in this area.

Vocabulary is a strength, with frequent high-level content and some skilful collocation [*spend valuable time* | *affecting children* | *maintain a stronger bond*]. Some errors remain [*falling back* / *falling behind*]. Grammatical structures are also varied and show some flexibility and some multi-clause sentences. However, most sentences are not error-free, as there are slips with prepositions [*to every child* / *for every child* | *in holiday* / *on holiday*] and plurals [*shorter period of holidays* | *side* / *sides*] and some missing punctuation.

To achieve a higher score, the candidate could explore the 'value of long holidays' and 'arguments for shorter holidays' in more depth. A greater degree of accuracy in vocabulary and grammatical structures would also improve the score.

TEST 3, WRITING TASK 1

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 5.0** score.

The illustration show information about a public library in a city which called Little Charfont. The member of library is mostly compose by Adults. It is around in half, the rawest is adults 65 and over.

Fiction is the most popular category either children or adults. Both of them are recorded by 38%. Wheras, nonfiction is less popular than fiction. It is 13% and 6% for children. The visualisation's categories, such as DVDs and audio books are lowest in the same binding which is total number of loans.

The bar is starting as the lowest in 2007. It is about 15,000. However, It has been slowly rised up until 2011. Unfortunately, It is likely to decrease as 2009 during 2012 to 2013. Nevertheless, It has been surprisingly increased by 2016. In 2016, It break new record In the chart. It could be about 21,000!

Here is the examiner's comment:

This response does present data for each of the charts, and generally answers the question. There is limited detail though, for example, when describing the pie chart for the age of library members, we are told that the members are mostly adults, and those 65 and over are the [rawest]. There is no mention of children and young adults, and no reporting of the data in the pie chart itself. This means that only limited details are presented.

Ideas are organised, and there is an underlying sense of meaning but some lack of progression. Sentences are not fluently linked to each other. Cohesive devices tend to be overused [*which* | *Both* | *such as* | *However* | *Unfortunately* | *Nevertheless*], and some are faulty [*Wheras* / *Whereas*]. There is some reference [*It*], but this is used repetitively, especially in the last paragraph.

There is an attempt to use a range of vocabulary [*less popular* | *visualisation's* | *break new record*]; however, overall, the frequency of error, and the mistakes in word choice [*rawest* / *lowest* | *binding* / ?] limit the score for vocabulary. The range of grammatical structures is also limited. The response should be written using past tenses, as the data covers 2007 to 2016, but is mostly written in the present tense. Sentences are generally short, and the level of error is noticeable for the reader.

This response could be improved by including an appropriate overview, and providing greater accuracy across vocabulary and grammatical structures.

Example overview

In Little Chalfont Library, 2016, the majority of members were adults, with the most loans in the fiction category. Overall, from 2007 to 2016, loans increased to their highest level across the 10-year period shown.

TEST 3, WRITING TASK 2

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 7.5** score.

Many people nowadays have decided to stop flying or to limit the amount of times they use this form of transport. This will undoubtedly have great benefits for the environment, but it may mean that for individuals or businesses this can translate to higher expenses. I believe the disadvantages for individuals and businesses would be greater than the effects on the environment. This essay will discuss advantages and disadvantages of this

Environmental benefits of reduced airtravel would have a direct effect in the amount of pollution in the air, which would mean a greener planet. However, this would also mean a rise in the use of other types of transportation. For example, if the amount of cars, buses or trucks on the road increases this also means greenhouse gas emissions increase too.

On the other hand, for individuals or businesses this could mean higher travelling costs, as well as lengthy trips and possible delays in reaching their destinations. All of this can affect the companies resources and even possibly cause them to lose business deals, or not even commence them due to restricted trading times. Higher costs for companies can cause job cuts which can have devastating effects for families.

In conclusion, I believe the disadvantages on individuals and businesses caused by a reduction in air travel are far greater. The potential implications for companies of higher travel and shipping costs, could reflect losses that can eventuate in job cuts. The effects on the environment would not be enough to merit such a drastic culture change and possibly pollution levels could rise as a result of the increase on other contaminants.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is a strong, detailed and well-developed response. There are several appropriate ideas; the position is presented in the first paragraph and it is evidenced consistently. To improve this response, there could be more detail on the impact on 'individuals' as most of the examples refer to 'businesses'.

The ideas are organised logically and the paragraphs support overall coherence. Cohesion is used well throughout, and the message can be followed easily.

Vocabulary is fluently and flexibly used [*translate to higher expenses* | *devastating effects* | *potential implications*] with accurate spelling and only occasional errors in word choice [*commence them* / *start them* | *eventuate in* / *result in*]. Similarly, the range of grammatical structures is wide. There are frequent multi-clause sentences and the response is mostly error free.

TEST 4, WRITING TASK 1

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 6.0** score.

The given diagram describes the process of manufacturing bamboo fabrics.

Overall, the process includes a few main stages, which are shown on the diagram and are numbered from 1 to 8.

The first stage, obviously, consists of planting and growing bamboo plants, usually happening in spring.

The second phase, We could say harvesting one, is happening in the middle part of the year in autumn. Bamboo stems are cutting off by the season workers, collecting and sendening to the special plants during this period.

In the plants, what are showed a the third and the forth stages. on the diagram, the bamboo stems are cutting into long strips, then produced strips are crushing to make liquid pulp.

During the next phase these pulp is filtering through the special types of sieves to separate long fibres from liquid.

Then the fibres, filtered by previous step, are being undergone through the softenning procedure. This procedure includes adding water and amine oxide.

The seventh stage is the sppinning the soften fibres to make a strong bamboo thread.

Produced yarns might be used to make fabric, which is the last – eighth phase, by weaveing them using special equipment.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is generally a good response, and it presents the key stages shown in the process. There is an overview, but it is rather generic and only tells us how many main stages there are [*main stages...are numbered from 1 to 8*]. To improve the overview, instead of reporting the number of stages, there should be a summary of the main stages.

Ideas are arranged logically. There are some nice linking expressions, appropriate for a 'process' [*The first stage | then | During the next phase | which is*] but there is some repetition [*The first stage | The second phase | third and the forth stages | next phase | seventh stage | eighth phase*]. Most of the sentences start on a new line – this means paragraphing is not present.

Vocabulary is appropriate and spelling is generally well managed but there are errors. Grammatical structures are mixed but errors in verb forms are noticeable, particularly in passive structures [*are cutting / are cut | are being undergone / undergo*].

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To achieve a higher score, the candidate should present an overview which summarises the main stages and paragraphing should be used to better organise the stages.

Example overview

The main stages of bamboo fabric production include harvesting bamboo plants, putting them through processes to extract the fibres, then spinning and weaving those fibres to create fabric.

Please note: Responses do not need to include a 'title' in IELTS Writing tasks.

TEST 4, WRITING TASK 2

This is an answer written by a candidate who achieved a **Band 7.0** score.

The way many of us are dressed today is believed to be affected by the fashion industry. The reason why it is so important for some people to choose their clothes according to the trends may be in our dependence on what is popular at the moment which is a double-edged sword. Of course, trying to keep up with modern fads consumes pretty much time and energy, but is it really that negative in terms of maintaining individuality? To my mind, it is not.

Not surprisingly, global fashion has influenced people's tastes in clothing a great deal. We all see those celebrities on TV and on the Internet boasting their brand new outfit making many men and women jealous. Would blond hair in concert with a white dress have been so popular back in the day if it had not been for the voluptuous Marilyn Monroe? world-wide famous fashion designers keep surprising consumers with their wild imagination producing more and more types of style. For instance over-sized winter coats have drawn attention not only from the youth but from the middle-aged as well.

Fashions by many are believed to dictate people how to look. They impose new styles, and some people wear certain clothes just because another designer told them to do so.

Looking on the bright side, there's absolutely no harm in getting advice from the fashion industry on what to wear this season. Moderation is the key. Do not overdo it. If you put on a garment that is really comfortable and suitable for you, it does not really matter whether it is fashionable or not. Your individuality won't be hurt if you simply like something that is in trend.

Here is the examiner's comment:

This is a strong response overall. The first part, on the influence of global fashion trends is clear and detailed: people are influenced because they see celebrities on TV and the internet, want to copy famous icons like Marilyn Monroe, continue to be surprised by designers, wild imagination and experience more and more styles.

The response to the second part is less well covered. The 'negative' side of this question is not addressed very thoroughly, apart from saying it takes [*time and energy*] to keep up with modern fads. The 'positives' include that there is [*no harm in getting advice*] on what to wear. More focus on the second part would improve the response.

Progression is logical. Linking expressions are appropriate [*Of course | For instance | Looking on the bright side*] with some good examples of reference [*their | those | another*] and paragraphing is helpful (although paragraphs 3 and 4 could be combined as they cover the same idea).

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Vocabulary use is strong with some precise meanings and effective collocation [*keep up* | *modern fads* | *influenced people's tastes* | *impose new styles*] there are some small slips in spelling [*important* | *maintainig* | *voloptious*] although the meaning is clear. Sentences are varied and contain complex structures. There are multi-clause sentences with a range of structures, including conditionals [*if*], but a few errors remain.

Overall, this is a good response. To achieve a higher score, the candidate should include a few more ideas around the 'positive or negative' influence of global fashion trends.